

Joint Learning Agenda

Strengthening Evidence for Anticipatory Action

A shared framework for coordinated evidence generation, 2026–2030

Overview for the validation meeting

October 2026

What we are here to do

1

Review agenda

Recap the agenda through the slides to get the conversation going.

2

Overall sentiments

Identify what should be added and what needs expansion.

3

Discuss the first round of comments

Work through specific comments and resolve them together.

4

Wrap up for Berlin

Agree way forward and to see if a working version to present at the Global Dialogue Platform as a living document, for a second round of feedback.

How we started and where we are?

FAO workshop, Rome *April 2026*

“Leveraging Evidence for Effective Anticipatory Action” — 50+ speakers, 150+ participants.

WFP Global Impact Evaluation Forum *Geneva, Sep 2026*

Refined priorities; the OCHA-WFP AA evidence window focusing on Impact Evaluations can be situated within the agenda.

ISDC roundtable & partner consultations *Berlin, Sep 2026*

Evidence in fragile settings; bilateral inputs from partners.

Living document *Ongoing*

Continues to evolve through contributions from participating stakeholders.





The case for acting early is made; the frontier has moved

A strong base to build on

A decade of rigorous studies across geographies and hazards shows that reaching people before a shock protects food security, reduces harmful coping and preserves assets.

The question has changed

The frontier is now making anticipatory action work better: which design features matter, how short-term protection lasts, and how costs compare.

No single study can answer it

These are comparative questions. Answering them means moving from individual studies to a shared effort — especially as funding tightens.

A shared framework: not a platform or a fund

An overarching structure under which the efforts of individual institutions are **systematised**, so each contribution is magnified by being **comparable with and cumulative to** the work of others. Partners keep designing, funding and implementing their own studies; the agenda aligns them.

FOCUSED SCOPE

Evidence on the impact, effectiveness and cost-effectiveness of anticipatory action for the people it aims to protect.

WHO IT IS FOR

Open to any organisation that generates, finances or uses AA evidence — UN agencies, Red Cross / Red Crescent, NGOs, researchers, banks, donors and governments.

WHAT IT ADDS

Early visibility of others' studies, shared baselines, stronger joint resource mobilisation, and findings that carry more weight because they are comparable.

Agenda key objectives

Roadmap for evidence building

An overarching framework that builds on and complements existing work rather than duplicating it.

Shared reference for progress & expectations

A common view of what is known, what remains open, and what AA can and cannot realistically achieve.

A bridge from evidence to action

Putting both existing and new findings to work in programme design, financing and policy.

A lever for mobilising resources

Partners pool effort and use each other's commitments to attract funding — without necessarily pooling budgets.

Four priority gaps identified in the Agenda (so far)

An initial, evolving set. a starting point to be refined with the community, not a fixed scope.

GAP 1

Conditions under which AA works best

Timing and sequencing, cash vs in-kind and multi-sectoral packages, which design features drive outcomes.

GAP 2

Linkages with long-term outcomes & resilience

Whether gains last through the season and across repeated shocks, and how they connect to resilience.

GAP 3

Cost-effectiveness & value for money

A common method for avoided losses, added benefits, and the full costs of readiness and delivery.

GAP 4

Coverage

Deliberately diversifying the evidence base — multi-hazard settings, under-represented regions and livelihoods.

Agenda proposition on how studies are chosen and conducted

- **Decision-relevant.** Each study starts from the decision it must inform, not from the method.
- **Build on what exists.** Existing evidence is used and put to work before new studies are commissioned.
- **Transparent, tiered rigour.** Most rigorous methods where feasible, robust alternatives elsewhere — stated openly, not pooled as equivalent.
- **Comparable by design.** Common measurement module applied where feasible; key context documented so findings travel.
- **Proportionate & ethical.** Data collection limited to what is needed; communities treated as partners, not only respondents.

Seven actions, aligned to the gaps

1. **Critical mass of evidence**
   ≥10 rigorous studies by 2030, selected as a portfolio.
2. **Common measurement module**
   A small shared set of core indicators and a common costing approach.
3. **Living inventory of studies**
   A public map of completed and ongoing evaluations, building on the Anticipation Hub.
4. **Evaluation-ready studies**
   Joint evaluations with shared baselines, prepared ahead of activations.
5. **Open data**
   Anonymised portfolio data shared under agreed protocols.
6. **From evidence to action**
   Findings timed and packaged as briefs for the decisions they inform.
7. **Stakeholder engagement**
   Governments, donors and communities engaged in shaping and using the evidence.

Light governance and Open financing mechanism

Participating stakeholders and core group

Define priorities, contribute studies and data, endorse the agenda by consensus.

Specialists who carry substantive work between meetings — priorities, the module, portfolio review, synthesis.

AA MEAL Working Group/AA Task Force

Informal secretariat: facilitates the process, maintains the agenda and the inventory.

Leads advocacy and links to programming; turns findings into messages for donors and governments.

FINANCING: POSSIBILITY A

Individual studies

Financed by partners: singly, or jointly where interests align. Partners leverage each other's commitments to attract further funding.

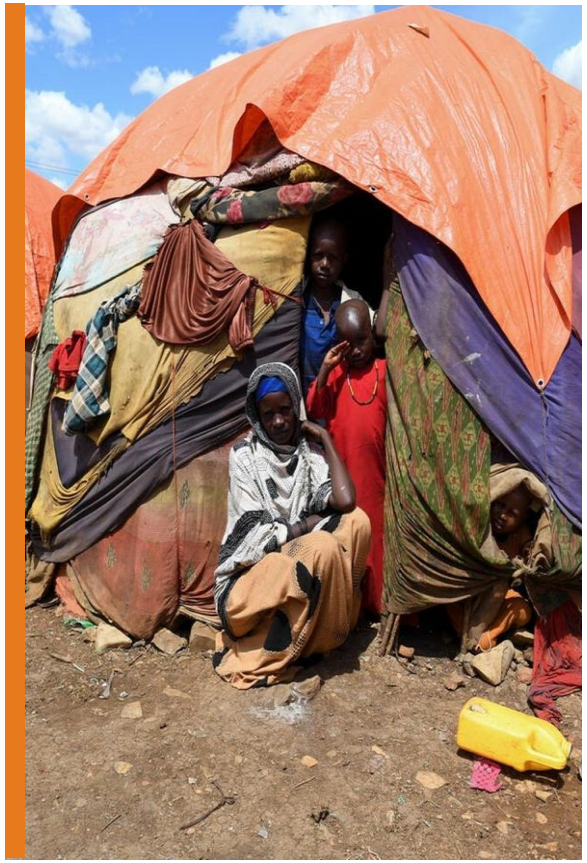
FINANCING: POSSIBILITY B

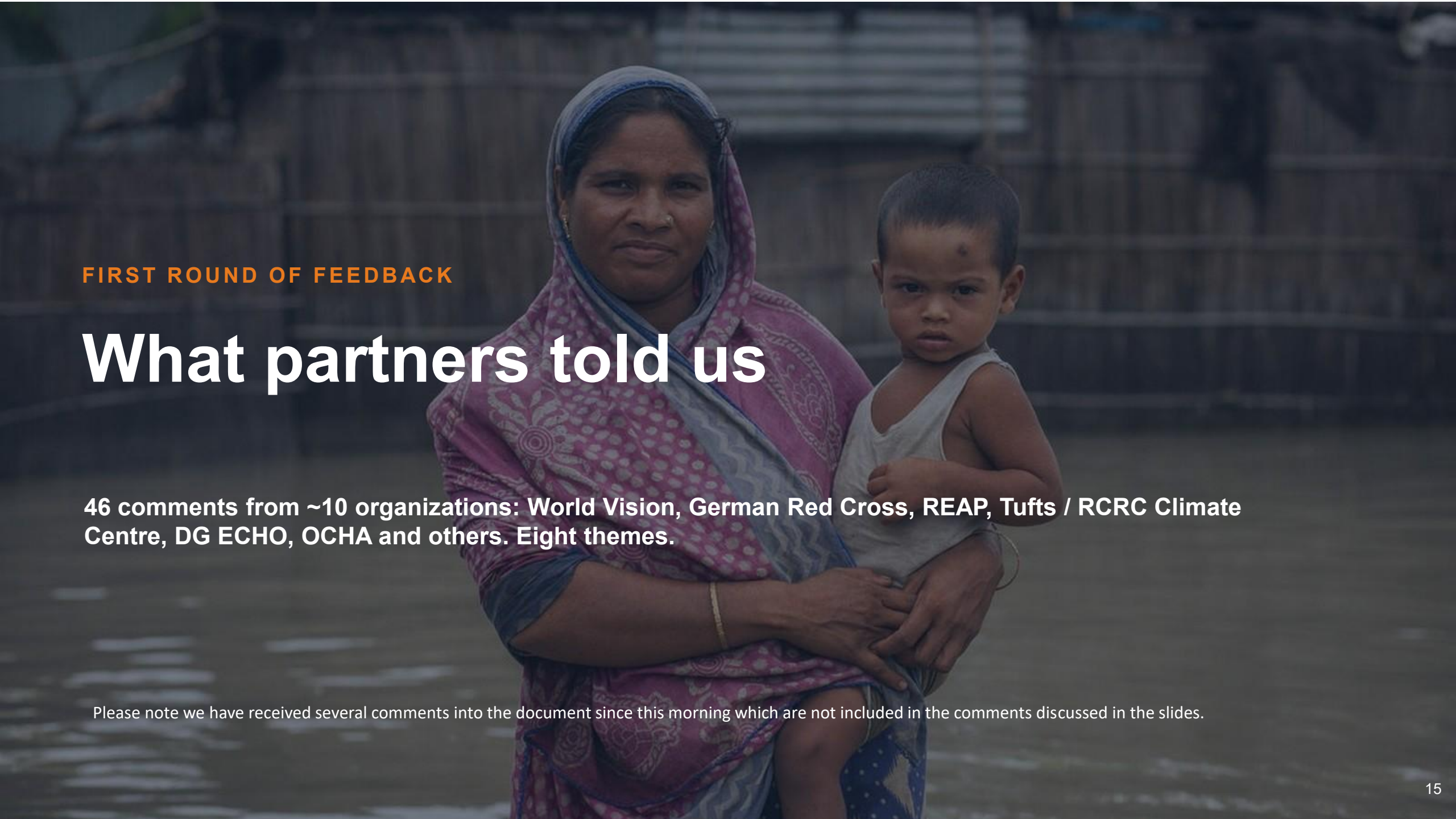
Shared functions

Modest joint resources for the common measurement module, the inventory of studies, and the synthesis of results.

Measuring success of the agenda

1. Organizations that have formally endorsed the agenda
2. Studies in the portfolio, including joint evaluations with shared baselines
3. Share of AA evaluations applying the common measurement module
4. Pooled analyses completed across countries and hazards
5. Documented cases where this evidence informed a programmes, scaling or financing decision





FIRST ROUND OF FEEDBACK

What partners told us

46 comments from ~10 organizations: World Vision, German Red Cross, REAP, Tufts / RCRC Climate Centre, DG ECHO, OCHA and others. Eight themes.

Please note we have received several comments into the document since this morning which are not included in the comments discussed in the slides.

Scope & framing: what evidence, and for whom?

- Clarify whether the agenda is about what works in AA (and what doesn't) or the case for AA vs response. *GRC*
- Clarify whether we are still about “make the case” of if AA works while the questions have moved to “making AA work better”. *GRC*
- Broaden scope to the country / national-policy perspective, not only how organizations coordinate. *REAP*
- Title risks confusion with “learning” as training; keep JLAA and gloss “learning” as evidence. *GRC*
- Be explicit on whether scope reaches beyond the humanitarian sector (development, climate). *Tufts / Climate Centre*

Gap 1 (Optimal conditions) and Gap 2 (Long-term outcomes)

- Add an explicit targeting question: who benefits most, and the right targeting approach for AA. *CRS / GRC (x2)*
- Add delivery channel as a design feature (UN, government social protection, local & faith-based). *World Vision*
- Clarify “trigger timing”; include return period / event severity. Is AA better for frequent or rare events? *DG ECHO*
- Questions may be too broad to answer well: design features differ by hazard and country. *Tufts / Climate Centre*
- Make children explicit in Gap 2: nutrition, continuity of education, protection risks (child labor, early marriage). *World Vision*
- Capture developmental outcomes: poverty, productivity, protection of private investment to attract development / private funding. *DG ECHO*
- Welcomed as a genuine addition the Window does not cover. *Tufts / Climate Centre*
- Make expected long-term effects proportionate to dose: 1–2 months of assistance cannot yield lasting outcomes. *(reviewer)*

Cost-effectiveness, coverage and equity

- Define and distinguish cost-effectiveness vs cost-benefit analysis and set a standard method before studies are pooled. *CRS / GRC*
- Specify perspective of analysis: opportunity cost: what else would that actor fund? *Tufts / Climate Centre (x2)*
- Compare against longer-term investments, not only emergency response; cite the recent OCHA fiscal-savings study. *DG ECHO*
- Include readiness costs and “no-regret” value, and un-triggered frameworks (52% never activated, CARE 2026). *World Vision*
- Consider merging cost-benefit into each study rather than a stand-alone gap. *(reviewer)*
- Apply common disaggregation by sex, age and disability across all studies: x3 *World Vision, REAP*
- Treat fragile and conflict-affected settings as a knowledge gap, not only an evaluation obstacle (one experimental study to date). *World Vision*

Governance, WFP–OCHA Window and Effort Duplication

- Clarify how the agenda relates to the WFP–OCHA impact evaluation window, and how NGOs can take part / co-design. *World Vision*
- Several parts may already exist. For example, the MEAL WG guidelines and the Window already cover indicators, costing, readiness and the priority questions. What does the agenda add rather than repeat? *OCHA (Daniel Pfister)*
- Guard against adding to fragmentation: with learning budgets shrinking, we should use the given budget on existing infrastructure rather than creating a parallel process. *OCHA (Daniel Pfister)*
- Be clear what changes in practice. Agencies already evaluate jointly; the Window already uses a technical coordinator and a feasibility screen. *OCHA*
- Add a clear implementation plan and budget; if it updates the MEAL WG's work, consider taking it forward within that group. *OCHA*
- Would the Anticipation Hub be the logical host? State FAO's intended hosting; make explicit the AA MEAL WG is a Hub working group. *GRC*
- Clarify who selects studies for the shared portfolio; add national, regional and global policy processes to engagement and uptake. *Tufts / Climate Centre · REAP*

Rigour, standards and data-sharing

- Narrative must match method strength e.g., baseline/endline cannot attribute; methodologies have limits, and assumptions stated. *(reviewer)*
- Use existing MEAL WG common indicators rather than defining new ones. *(reviewer)*
- Allow for wide range of studies. Different audiences find different evidence credible — quantitative vs narrative / success stories. *(reviewer)*
- Set minimum methodological standards and name who sets and reviews them. *OCHA (Daniel Pfister)*
- Explain, for non-researchers, why data is shared: perhaps for replication, secondary and meta-analysis. *GRC*
- Not all data need be shared with everyone; soften to results, where feasible, under agreed protocols. *GRC (x2)*
- Build in an uptake / implementation element — there is a known research-to-practice gap (implementation science). *Tufts / Climate Centre*

OPEN DISCUSSION

Where we would value your input

- Overall, does the framing and scope feel right?
- What is missing, and what needs expansion?
- Are the four gaps correct and enough or shall we add more priorities to lead with?
- Comments that needs to be addressed
- High-level comments to be addressed before the light launch in Berlin

Next: Finalize a working version to present at the Global Dialogue Platform (Berlin) next week as a living document for a second round of feedback.

Proposed timeline and future

PHASE 0

2026

Living document

Open for comment; working version presented at the Global Dialogue Platform, Berlin.

PHASE 1

late 2026–early 2027

Validation & endorsement

Priorities validated, partners endorse, technical core group formed, module drafted.

PHASE 2

2027–2030

Coordinated evidence generation

Joint evaluations under the common module; mid-term stocktake in 2028.

PHASE 3

2030

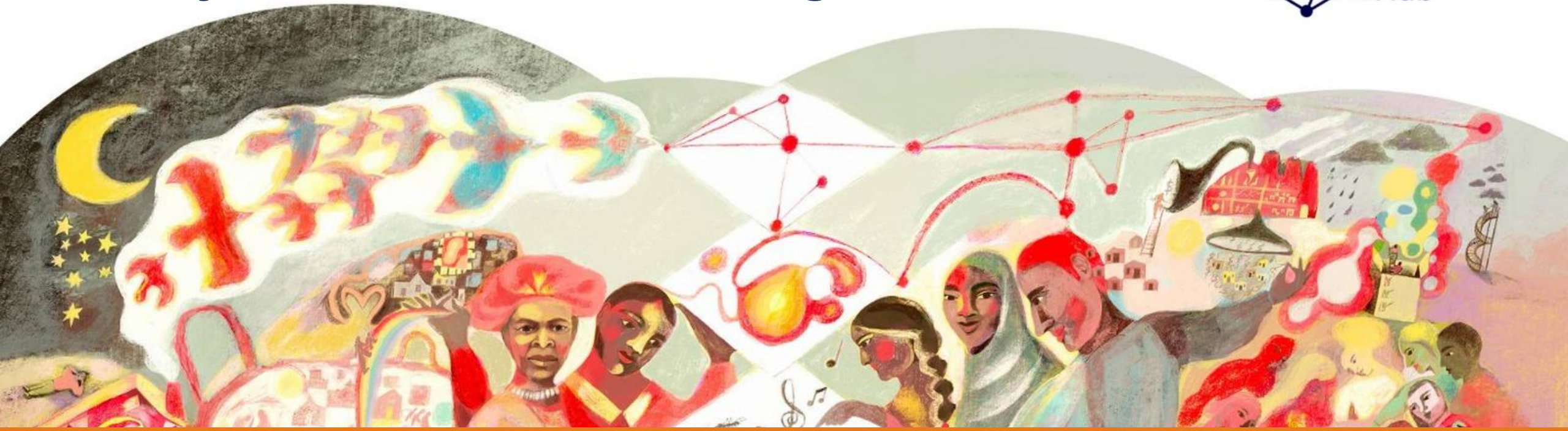
Synthesis & uptake

Findings synthesised and communicated to inform scaling and financing decisions.

NEXT STEPS

See you at the Global Dialogue Platform

hosted by the Anticipation Hub



We look forward to seeing you in Berlin and continuing the discussion in person.

Soft launch. Niccolò Lombardi and Kamran Khan Niazi will soft-launch this document in a plenary session on 21 October.

Session 21. A dedicated session on joint evidence, what it means to organizations and what organizations are prioritizing at their end is also scheduled at the Global Dialogue Platform on October 21 at 15.30 CEST.